MINI-GAME EXPANSION

WORLD BUILDER'S GUIDE

Populate the Fantasy Setting

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Introduction

Welcome to the Mini-Game Expansion, a rules expansion for D&D 4E. The goals of this expansion are to introduce house rules that improve the existing game, and to add new rules that streamline and automate the game. For example, the DMG has suggestions for how to run skill challenges, as well as ideas for terrain rules in combat scenarios. This expansion standardizes those choices in order to remove focus from the repeated routines and speed up the game. It consist of three rule books: House Rules, StoryTelling System, and World Builder's Guide.

The House Rules book starts by defining the core rules that the expansion uses from the official rules set. It provides a completely new weapons table, which is a major rules revision. It standardizes the combat setup routine as well as the post-combat looting, greatly increasing the value of skills. It also provides entirely new types of combat, such as the trapped area and the chase.

The StoryTelling System book introduces a new framework for standardizing and automating the adventuring tasks. For each task, such as purchasing magic items or traveling cross-country, a complete set of rules is provided so that players can run the task themselves. This frees up the DM so their role becomes general oversight, and not micro-management. Additionally, there are the Weekly Quests, which are randomly generated mini-quests. They are repeatable and are also run by the players themselves - eliminating the need for the DM to create new storylines for every single game day. Again, the routine tasks and Weekly Quests make skills an intrinsic part of the game, so just creating a power-game combat character is not enough to be succesfull.

The World Builder's Guide book is designed to automate the creation of the campaign setting from the inside out. It start with a region, which sets the geography (mountains, seas, etc) and biomes (forest, swamp, etc). A region is populated with kingdoms, which are built by civilized races from the Monster Manual. Kingdoms have a technology level, religion, factions, and settlements. Settlements can be of different sizes (as defined in DMG), and also have specific shops, services, faction buildings, etc. Additionally, there is an encounter group generator available online which is the best in the world.

CHAPTER ONE

GEOGRAPHY

OVERVIEW

Inspired by TSR's "World Builder's Guidebook", this manual gives structure to the process of creating a fantasy game world. It is meant as a setting builder, automating the creation of such things as mountains and rivers, but also the famous persons of a given town. It is not meant for creating adventure plots, or building interiors. The World Builder goes in tandem with the StoryTelling System, and thus is designed around the rules and races of D&D 4E.

Inside-out approach

territory
creating adjacent territories
how to draw them? each territory in own map, or all together in a region map?
    this should be based on the map-creation software used,
        because you could create one large complete map, and then just print subsets of it

settlement

Domains

Geography

topology: the physical shape of the land
    can be plains, hills, mountains, sea, ocean (sea adjacent to sea)
    topology stays constant for 3-5 territories

climate: combination of latitude and humidity
    latitude: tropical, subtropical, temperate, subarctic, arctic
    humidity: humid, arid
    latitude stays constant for all east-west adjacent territories,
        stays constant for 8 north-south territories
    territories that are 2-adjacent to sea are humid, internal continents are arid

biome: the vegetation of the area, varies with the climate
    stays constant for 2-3 territories
    mountains increase the latitude by 1 towards cold
    jungle, rainforest, forest, taiga
    savanna/shrubland, grassland/steppe/prairie, tundra
    swamp, marsh
    rocky cactus desert, barren/sand dunes/salt flats, snowy desert, glacier

hydrography: local modifications to the topology
    can be river, lake, valley, floating islands

PROPERTIES

Race: typically a domain has a major race which is intelligent and builds a civilization of some kind
  races with social empireal can have all progress levels
    races with social barbarian are limited in progress levels
    can be intelligent, non-intelligent, or not even exist. includes languages.

Languages:
Alignment:
Deities: PHB 21, DMG 162 ?
Population Block: human 500, eladrin 300, goblin 750

Progress Level: measures how advanced the civilization is

Progress Levels

Progress Level	Required Race Level Range		Factions
None	0-1		0
Stone Age	2-3		4
Iron Age	4-6		6
Middle Ages	7-9		8
	10+		

Domain Type:
new system: don't model villages. instead create towns and cities, and let villages just lie along the roads every 10-20km. for stone age, just create nomadic paths, no roads or settlements. crossroads can be something at that point

Geographic Area: the distance between 2 adjacent settlements should be 1-3 days of riding. so the "travel-area" of 1 settlement has a 2-day-ride diameter. that times the number of total settlements in the territory gives the expected geographical area

List of Factions:

List of Settlements:

Domain Types

Roll 1d10 + Level Range	Type	Progress Level	Bur	Tow	Bor	Cit	Met
	Nomad Tribes	Stone Age	6	-	-	-	-
	War Clans		4	3			
	Fiefdom	Iron Age					
	Proto City States						
11 – 13	Kingdom						
14 – 16	Kingdom	Middle Ages					
17 – 19	City States						
20	Empire						

lower domain types must have smaller settlements for historical accuracy

POPULATION RACES

Race Definition: Monster races come from the monster manual (aka MM) rule books included in the MGX as part of the core rules. A *race* is a heading in a monster manual. A monster *entry* is a particular instance of the race. For example: "elf" is the race, and "elf scout" is the entry. This definition serves to combine the same race across different monster source rules.

Ally Groups: The MM's have some suggested encounter groups for monsters, but they are pathetic. The mini-game expansion uses *ally groups* as an additional monster trait that is used to associate monsters that are likely to work together. The ally groups are automatically used by the website's encounter generator. For example: goblins, hobgoblins and orcs all have the "horde" ally group. By selecting "horde" in the encounter generator, it uses monsters that have that ally group to create the encounter group.

Civilization: There is a glaring problem when using the monster entries in the core rules to populate an entire game world. The issue is that some races, particularly the standard races (elf, dwarf, gnome, etc), don't have enough monster entries to represent their forces appropriately. For example: elves only have a level 2 skirmisher and a level 2 artillery. This makes it virtually impossible to create a level 6 elf monster encounter. This is non-sense because then an elf army could never defend itself against orcs, which have a level range of 3 to 10.

A great solution to this problem is to create new monster entries that fill in the gaps for the races that require it. That is, making elf monster entries of higher levels and with different roles, like the human entries. Existing monsters can also be upgraded with rules from the DMG. There are also utilities available online for creating new monsters with listings formatted like the core sources. Alas, this solution requires a lot of time for little gain. Instead, the concept of civilizations is used.

A civilization is a special kind of ally group. It fills a race's civilization group with monsters entries from other races that make sense with it. For example: the elf civilization is composed of elf (levels 2, 2), skulk (levels 3, 3, 5), half-elf (levels 6, 7) and tiger (levels 6, 8). Therefore, elves go from having 2 entries with a level range of 2 to 2, to having 9 entries with a level range of 2 to 8. Now if a level 5 elf encounter is necessary, it can be created from skulks and half-elves. This solution works really well to save time and effort, but it is a bit of hack and requires that the flavor text and some rules of the extra races to be changed during play. For example: the skulk's alignment would be changed to the elf's alignment, the tiger however can stay as is. For extra credit, you can remove the skulk's racial ability *stealthy step*, and replace it with the elves racial ability *elven accuracy*.

Domain Race: Civilizations are the cornerstone of the game world's population. They are used as the race that domains belong to. That is, a domain can only belong to a race that has a civilization group. What this means is that humans, goliath, goblins, ogres, giants, sahuagin, etc can have domains, whereas displacer beasts and beholders cannot.

The domain races can be found on the website under "Monster Tools / Domain Races". This application can be used to randomly generate a domain race, or just choose from the list. When a domain race is being determined randomly, the application uses the number of entries in a race's civilization as the frequency for that race.

CULTURE

defined by:
a race
a domain on the world map
a language

a combination of:
tools developed, materials used
architecture
economy
politics

FACTIONS

Every domain has all of the sectors that compose a society: paupers, laborers, skilled tradesmen, government, militia, land owners, etc. Each sector has it's corresponding responsibilities: goods production, trade regulation, law enforcement, entertainment, construction, raising the young, medical services, education, etc. A faction is a sector of a domain that is especially important for some reason. That reason can be great wealth, historical lineage, popular appeal, powerful magic, high competence, providing of specialized services, be outcasts, etc. They may be identified by economic status, politics, religion, role in production, being of a minority race, or other factors. The group of factions of a domain define it's culture, history, and inner workings.

Domain Factions: The number of factions that a domain has is based on it's progress level and type. Factions are divided into types, each with their own subtypes as shown on the next table. Selecting the faction types can be done by choice or randomly. However, there must always be at least 1 commoner and 1 noble faction in a territory. Also, there must be at least 1 of each faction type (except for racial group) before any faction has multiple subtypes. The factions are mostly designed around a real-world human medieval society, so some adapting will need to be done. For example, what is does it mean for temples to be in an orc kingdom – are they centers of healing and community, or of power and control?

Faction Archetypes

Faction Type	Subtype	Description
Commoner	Crop Grower	Grains, vegetables, fruits.
	Cattle Rancher	Bovine, sheep, horses, poultry, fish.
	Smith & Artisan	Blacksmiths, builders, leatherworkers.
Nobility	Noble Council	Nobles have consolidated power over land, labor and law.
	Glory Days	Nobles are being substituted by merchant class.
	Civil War	Noble families are actively vying against each other.
Government	Temple	Community building and aid for the downtrodden.
	Local Militia	The city guard and the law are very strong.
	Military	There is a standing army for foreign invasions.
Militia	Mercenaries	The culture caters to adventurers and sell-swords.
	Hunter-trappers	An industry around hunting local game.
Industry	Trade Guild	Trade is a cornerstone of the economy.
	Wizard School	Advances in engineering and astronomy.
	Entertainment	Thespian, gambling, prostitution associations.
Shadow	Thief Guild	Organized crime. Can be multiple warring factions.
	Cult	Underground cult that sabotages main society.
	Monastery	Psionics are typically shunned and misunderstood.
Racial Group	Minor Race	The minor race of territory, if it exists.

Game Theory

How to create a domain's settlements based on the race's monster statistics?
- monster statistics available are: frequency, level range, social type?
- level range is 3 things: a minimum, a maximum, and their difference (the delta)

Option 1: The domain level is a random value between 1 and the frequency.
- good because I can control the frequency, no social type necessary
- bad because each civilization race would have to be fine-tuned

Option 2: The domain level is a random value between level_min and level_max. The social type modifies the number and types of settlements available.
- so if a race has a low level delta, they won't have large kingdoms

Settlements

Properties

Name: The name of the settlement.

Domain: The domain that the settlement belongs to. The domain sets the settlement's most likely geography. The climate is most often the same as the domain's. The biome and topology can change if the domain spans a very large area. The hydrography can vary widely within a domain.

Races: A settlement can have up to 2 races. Roll 1d6: on a 5+ the settlement has a 2 races. The major race is the domain's race. The minor race is a different race that more often than not shares an *ally group* with the major race. The minor race composes about 25% of the population of the settlement.

Size: A measure of the settlement's population and wealth. This property is explained in the next heading. The size of a settlement determines it's level, population and number of factions.

Guardians: Settlements are guarded by the local militia. However, they also have a guardian which is their last line of defense. If the guardian of a settlement is destroyed, the settlement is converted to the faction of those that destroyed it. The guardians are one encounter group which is much higher level than the settlement. A guardian monster must have the keyword 'construct'. They range from the homunculi to the golems to the colossi.

Factions: The domain's factions which are prevalent in this particular settlement. This property is explained in a next heading.

Services: Tools for the PCs that are always available in a settlement. This property is explained in a next heading.

Businesses: Tools for the PCs that are sometimes available in a settlement. This property is explained in a next heading.

SETTLEMENT SIZE

Definition: The size of a settlement is equivalent with its population. The size quantity is given in terms of population blocks. For example, humans have a population block of 500, so a human burg with 4 population blocks has around 2000 people. The population blocks are equivalent with the level of the settlement.

Settlement Size

Size	Level Mod	Max Pop (Human)	Pop Blocks	Pop Roll
Hamlet	-	500	1 – 1	1
Village	-	1,000	2 – 2	2
Burg	0-1	6,000	3 – 12	1d10 +2
Town	2-3	12,000	13 – 24	1d12 +12
Borough	4-6	25,000	25 – 47	2d12 +23
City	7-9	50,000	48 – 92	4d12 +44
Metropolis	10+	100,000		

Level: The level of a settlement impacts several of its other properties. Encounter groups of the settlement, such as guards, bandits, or cultists, are based on the settlement level. The level of businesses is also based on the settlement's level.

Determining Level: The level of a settlement is equal to the race's minimum level plus the *level mod* of the settlement. The minimum level of a race is equal to the lowest level amongst all the race's monster entries. This value is available on the website under "Monster Tools / Domain Races". The level mod of a settlement is determined randomly.
what about domain level?
For example: the minimum level of "elf" is 2, so if there is a elven town, it's level will be 4 to 5, which is 2 plus 2 to 3.
this also means that the maximum settlement level of a race is determined by it's maximum monster entry level. For example elves have a level range of 2 to 8.

racial frequency: number of monster entries
racial level range: same as monster entries' level range

nevermind, don't use max population per city, just model the level of the settlement, that way stone age cultures can have high level settlements. give each settlement a base population, but then multiply by a factor given by the domain type. so the higher the type, the more population. so the population entry is just for flavor, what matters is the settlement level

FACTIONS

List of Factions: A settlement has some, but not all, the factions of its domain. The factions present in a settlement are there because of its particular history, geography, or culture. For example, in a capital city, the government faction is especially strong. A settlement has a number of factions given by its size. The factions of a settlement can be selected randomly or by choice, but they should vary among all the settlements of a domain.

Faction Power: Each faction has a certain amount of influence within a settlement known as its *power*. The power of a faction is given as a percentage, with all of a settlement's factions adding to 100%. To create the faction powers of a settlement, start with an even distribution among all factions, then apply 1d2 +1 "Faction Shift" historical events to them.

Settlement Factions

Size	Factions
Burg	1d2, 1 Commoner, No Nobility
Town	1d3 +1, 1 Commoner Or Nobility
Borough	1d4 +2, 1 Commoner, 1 Nobility
City	2d3 +3, 2 Commoner, 1 Nobility
Metropolis	

SERVICES

Service: A service is a part of the basic commerce of a settlement that is relevant to the PC's. A settlement always has all of the services that it qualifies for. Each service has different properties that must be defined when they are created.

Common Merchant: The common merchant sells and buys all mundane items as defined in the "Visit Common Merchant" scene. It represents all of the shops in the settlement and has these properties.

Faction: The faction is the same as the settlement's commoner faction.

Inn: An inn provides logging and other benefits as listed in the "Check in to Inn" party action. There are several inns in a settlement and they have these properties.

Number: The number of inns is equal to the number of factions that the settlement has.

Faction: Each inn belongs to a different faction.

Quality: An inn's quality (poor, medium, high) should be assigned based on its faction. For example a nobility faction inn is always high, whereas a cult's inn would be poor in order to draw less attention.

Road: Roads are formal connections between settlements. They have the following properties.

Quality: Roads can have "paved" or "path" quality. The "Traveling by Road" party action covers the other details of this.

Stable: A stable sells horses as defined in the "Travel Modes" party action. It has the following properties.

Requirement: Any settlement that has a paved road has a stable.

Faction: The stable's faction can be either the settlement's commoner or nobility faction.

Passenger Boat: Passenger boats provide transportation to other passenger boat locations as defined in the "Travel Modes" task. It has the following properties.

Requirement: Any settlement that borders a river has passenger boats.

Faction: The passenger boat's faction can be either the settlement's commoner or nobility faction.

Teleportation Circle: This service provides transport as defined in the "Travel Modes" task. It has the following properties.

Requirement: A settlement must be of at least Borough size to have this service.

Faction: The service belongs to an industry type faction of the settlement or territory.

BUSINESSES

Properties: A business provides for a specialized need that the PC's and others have. Each business has its own corresponding party action (see "StoryTelling System" book). Businesses are uniform in that they have the following properties.

Name: A business is very unique and carries an appropriate handle.

Level: The level of the business is a constant and reflects the quality of the workers as well as the goods provides. A business's level is set randomly by rolling on the next table.

Faction: The faction of a business should be randomly determined among the factions of the domain, excluding the commoner and nobility factions. Also, ensure that each settlement faction has a business before being double-assigned.

Business Type

Type	Description
Magic Vendor	Offers magic items from a random inventory. Also buys magic items.
Enchanter	Offers 1 chosen magic item per week.
Skintrader	Offers companion and mercenaries for hire.
Dojo	Gain XP in exchange for money.
Library	Research rituals.

Business Level

Roll (1d10)	Level
1 – 2	Settlement -2
3 – 4	Settlement -1
5 – 6	Settlement +0
7 – 8	Settlement +1
9 – 10	Settlement +2

Creating Businesses: There are two steps to create the businesses of a settlement. These steps may be taken with random rolls, or you may choose their result. First, the number of businesses is determined. Second, create each of the businesses individually. To create a business, enter all of its properties into the settlement listing.

Number of Businesses

Size	Number	Starting Roll
Burg	2	2
Town	3 – 4	1d2 +2
Borough	4 – 5	1d2 +3
City	5 – 6	1d2 +4
Metropolis	6 – 8	1d3 +5

Businesses Rotation

Roll (2d4)	Choose Business	
2 – 3		
4		
5		
6		
7 – 8		

Historical Events

Events: Historical events are changes to a settlement's properties. They can be generated by the DM or the party. For DM historical events, the DM applies 1 random historical event to each settlement that the party was in for that week. The party generates historical events at different times based on their party actions.

DM Historical Event

Roll 1d10	Event
1 – 2	Population Increase
3 – 4	Population Decrease
5 – 6	Business Change
7 – 8	Faction Shift
9 – 10	Guardians Destroyed

Population Increase: The settlement's population blocks are increased by 2d6. This may take the settlement's size up a level (see Settlement Size section above). If it does, all of the settlement's properties must be changed to match the new level. This includes the number of businesses, and the guardian monster types.

Population Decrease: The settlement's population blocks are decreased by 2d6. This may take the settlement's size down a level (see Settlement Size section above). If it does, all of the settlement's properties must be changed to match the new level. This includes the number of businesses, and the guardian monster types.

Business Change: The businesses of the settlement change based on a roll on the next table. The columns of the table refer to the number of businesses that the settlement is currently at. The minimum and maximum number of businesses that a settlement can have is given by the settlement's level (see the Business section above).

Business Change

Roll	Name
1 – 2	Tough Break
4 – 6	Bad Mojo
7 – 9	Streak of Luck
10 – 12	Major Upturn

Tough Break: Remove 1 random business from the settlement. If the settlement is already at the minimum number of businesses, then Bad Luck happens instead.

Bad Mojo: Reduce the level of a random business by 1d4, to the minimum allowed by settlement level.

Streak of Luck: Increase the level of a random business by 1d4, to the maximum allowed by settlement level.

Major Upturn Break: Add 1 business to the settlement by following the steps in the Business section above. If the settlement is already at the maximum number of businesses, then Streak of Luck happens instead.

Faction Shift: One faction has their power increased, while another decreases. If the shift is the result of a DM historical event, then the factions are decided at random. If the shift is result of a party action, then those rules determined which factions increase and decrease. Both factions change their power percentage by the same amount, which is 1d6 +4%.

Guardians Destroyed: The guardians of the settlement are destroyed by an invading force. They take control of the settlement and the party must flee it's area. This also creates a Liberation Quest for the current settlement. The invading force is a race of comparable level to the settlement, but can be from any plane. At the end of the week, control of the settlement returns to the original factions.

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CHAPTER TWO

ALPHA WORLD

SETTING OVERVIEW

Alpha World is the generic setting that accompanies the WBG. Its purpose is to provide a minimal setting where the mini-game expansion rules can be developed and tested.

Beta Kingdom

Geography

Topology: Hills
Climate: Subtropical
Biome: Forest
Local: River x1

Settlements

Type	Name
Borough	Gamma Town
Town	Deltaville
Burg	Zettaville

Demographics

Race: Human	Levels: 1 to 7
Progress Level: Iron Age	
Domain Type: Kingdom (partial)	
Alignment: Lawful Neutral	
Deities: Kord, Erathis, Pelor	
Language: Common	

FACTIONS

Cloven Tracks [Type: Commoner, Cattle Rancher]
The abundance of wild horse herds in the local area has led to a boom around their domestication for labor, warfare and cultural events.

House of Lords [Type: Nobility, Noble Council]
Each settlement has 1-3 noble families which own and oversee nearly all of the property, laws and labor in an early feudal system.

Kord's Favored [Type: Government, Local Militia]
The noble families are propped up by their retinues of Kord fanatics, each bearing their own heraldry. As a reflection of their god, they are more wild and impetuous than they are militaristic and hierarchical.

Brotherhood of the Sunstruck [Type: Militia, Hunter-Trappers]
The elite rangers of Pelor are a small group, but influential nonetheless. They have a relationship with the Cloven Tracks, keeping the wild herds safe from over-predation.

Erathian Guild [Type: Industry, Trade Guild]
The availability of horses has greatly spurred trade within the kingdom. This faction takes great inspiration in the methods and ideology of the god Erathis.

Cult of Bane [Type: Shadow, Cult]
An outlaw and underground cult of the evil god Bane. Their exact numbers are unknown, but it's very easy to recruit for Bane in a culture dominated by Kord.

Eye of Kalinsham [Type: Shadow, Monastery]
Monks and psions of all races gather in Beta Kingdom. They are neither welcome in society or persecuted, preferring to isolate themselves and keep their talents hidden.

Gamma Town

Properties

Domain: Beta Kingdom	
Size: Borough	Level: 5
Geography: Hills, Subtropical Forest	
Major Race: Human	Pop Blocks: 17
Minor Race: Goliath	Pop Blocks: 5

Factions

Type	Name
Nobility	House of Lords
Government	Kord's Favored
Industry	Erathian Guild
Shadow	Cult of Bane

Services

Service	Quality	Faction	Additional Information
Common Merchant	-	House of Lords	-
Inn	Medium	Kord's Favored	"Golden Axe"
Inn	High	House of Lords	"The Ludvig Estate"
Inn	Poor	Cult of Bane	"Black Cat"
Road	Road	-	To Deltaville
Road	Road	-	To Zettaville
Stable	-	House of Lords	-
Passenger Boat	-	House of Lords	To Deltaville

Businesses

Business	Level	Faction	Name
Magic Vendor	7	Erathian Guild	"Ummagumma's Emporium"
Skintrader	4	Br. of the Sunstruck	"Rainbow Circus"
Enchanter	6	Kord's Favored	"Might of Steel"
Magic Vendor	5	Eye of Kalinsham	"Sword & Staff"

DeltaVille

Properties

Domain: Beta Kingdom	
Size: Town	Level: 3
Geography: Hills, Subtropical Forest	
Major Race: Human	Pop Blocks: 11

Factions

Type	Name
Commoner	Cloven Tracks
Militia	Brotherhood of the Sunstruck
Shadow	Cult of Bane

Services

Service	Quality	Faction	Additional Information
Common Merchant	-	Cloven Tracks	-
Inn	Medium	Cloven Tracks	"The Silver Hoof"
Road	Road	-	To Gamma Town
Road	Path	-	To Zettaville
Stable	-	Cloven Tracks	-
Passenger Boat	-	Cloven Tracks	To Gamma Town

Businesses

Business	Level	Faction	Name
Skintrader	5	Br. of the Sunstruck	"The Early Bird"
Magic Vendor	4	Erathian Guild	"Road to Glory"
Dojo	3	Cult of Bane	"Fighting Pits"
Enchanter	2	Eye of Kalinsham	"The Mind's Eye"

ZettaVille

Properties

Domain: Beta Kingdom	
Size: Burg	Level: 2
Geography: Hills, Subtropical Forest	
Major Race: Human	Pop Blocks: 5

Factions

Type	Name
Commoner	Cloven Tracks
Shadow	Eye of Kalinsham

Services

Service	Quality	Faction	Additional Information
Common Merchant	-	Cloven Tracks	-
Inn	Poor	Cloven Tracks	"Pegasus Inn"
Inn	High	Eye of Kalinsham	"The Clairvoyant"
Road	Road	-	To Gamma Town
Road	Path	-	To Deltaville
Stable	-	Cloven Tracks	-

Businesses

Business	Level	Faction	Name
Magic Vendor	3	Kord's Favored	"Clanggedin's Hammer"
Skintrader	2	Eye of Kalinsham	"Cloud Dragon Temple"